



Rent an Apartment

Complete Guide to Renting an Apartment in Beijing as a Foreigner (2026)

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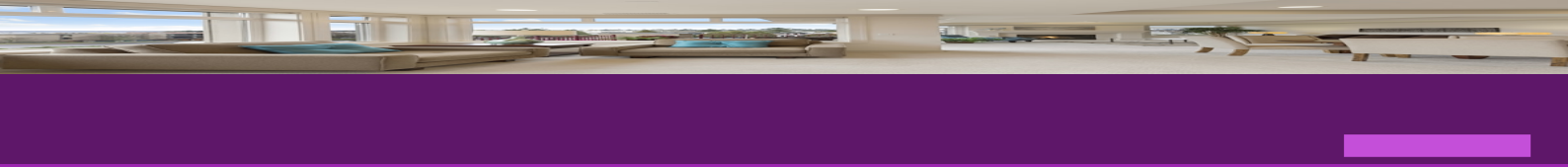
Moving to Beijing and finding the right apartment can feel overwhelming, especially when you don't speak Chinese fluently. This comprehensive guide covers everything you need to know about renting in Beijing as a foreign tenant -- from choosing the right platform to signing your lease.

Step 1: Choose the Right Rental Platform

The Beijing rental market is dominated by several major platforms. Here are the best options for foreigners:

- * Ziroom (自如)

- * -- China's largest managed apartment platform. Offers fully furnished, standardized



apartments with Wi-Fi, cleaning service, and maintenance included. The app has an English interface option. Best for: young professionals who want a hassle-free experience. Price range: ¥3,000-15,000/month.

* Lianjia (链家)

* -- The most trusted real estate platform in China with verified listings and professional agents. The app is in Chinese, but agents in expat areas often speak English. Best for: families and long-term renters. Commission: typically one month's rent.

* Beike (贝壳找房)

* -- A housing aggregator that pulls listings from multiple agencies including Lianjia. Has the largest database of verified properties. Best for: comparing options across agencies.

* HousingAnywhere

* -- International platform popular for medium-term rentals (1-12 months). Verified landlords, secure payments, and flexible lease terms. Best for: students and short-term

stays.

Step 2: Understand Beijing's Rental Neighborhoods

Beijing is massive -- choosing the right neighborhood is crucial. Here are the most popular areas for foreigners:

- * Chaoyang District (朝阳区)

- * -- The expat hub. Sanlitun, CBD, and Liangmaqiao are popular with young professionals. Rent: ¥5,000-15,000/month for 1BR.

- * Haidian District (海淀区)

- * -- Near major universities (Peking, Tsinghua). Wudaokou is the student hub. Rent: ¥4,000-8,000/month for 1BR.

- * Wangjing (望京)

- * -- Known as "Koreatown" but increasingly popular with all expats. Modern apartments,

great food scene. Rent: ¥4,500-9,000/month for 1BR.

* Shunyi District (顺义)

* -- Where most international schools are located. Villa communities with gardens.

Popular with expat families. Rent: ¥8,000-25,000/month for a villa.

Step 3: Documents You'll Need

* Valid passport with current visa

* Residence permit (临时住宿登记表) -- register at your local police station within 24

hours of moving in

* Proof of income or employment contract (some landlords require this)

* Security deposit: typically 1-2 months' rent (押一付三 = 1 month deposit, 3 months

upfront is standard)

Step 4: The Rental Process

Browse listings on your preferred platform and schedule viewings (看房 kàn fáng)

Visit apartments in person -- never sign without seeing the place first

Negotiate the rent -- in Beijing, it's common to negotiate 5-10% off the listed price

Review the lease contract carefully. Ask for an English translation if needed

Pay the deposit and first month's rent. Get official receipts (收据 shōu jù)

Register at the local police station (派出所 pài chū suǒ) within 24 hours

Step 5: Essential Tips for Foreign Renters

- * Always use a

- * reputable platform

- * -- avoid WeChat-only deals without verification

- * Check water pressure, heating system, and internet speed during viewing
- * In Beijing, central heating (暖气 nuǎn qì) is included in rent from Nov 15 - Mar 15
- * Negotiate who pays for utilities (水电费 shuǐ diàn fèi) -- usually the tenant
- * Get renter's insurance -- available on
- * Zhongmin
- * or through your agent
- * Join expat WeChat groups for your neighborhood for real-time advice

Common Scams to Avoid:

- * Agent asks for deposit before viewing -- SCAM. Never pay before seeing the apartment
- * Price is significantly below market rate -- likely bait-and-switch
- * Landlord refuses to provide 房产证 (property ownership certificate) -- verify ownership
- * No written contract -- always insist on a formal lease agreement



Sources: Sources: [Ziroom](https://www.ziroom.com) • [Lianjia](https://www.lianjia.com) • [Beike](https://www.ke.com)

The background of the cover is a photograph of a modern, bright interior space, likely a living or dining area, with large windows on the left showing a view of a city and water. The room features light-colored walls, a beige sofa, and a dining table with chairs. Overlaid on this background are several graphic elements: a large purple circle in the center, a solid purple rectangle in the top right corner, a solid purple rectangle in the bottom left corner, a solid black circle in the top left, and another solid black circle in the bottom right.

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